

Figure 6.18 Local winds of the world

Mistral: Cold northerly from central France and the Alps to Mediterranean.

Nor'easter: Strong winds from the northeast in the eastern United States, especially New England

Nor'wester: Wind that brings rain to the West Coast, and warm dry winds to the East Coast of New Zealand's South Island, caused by the moist prevailing winds being uplifted over the Southern Alps, often accompanied by a distinctive arched cloud pattern.

Pampero: Argentina, very strong wind which blows in the Pampa.

Simoom: Strong, dry, desert wind that blows in the Sahara, Israel, Jordan, Syria, and the desert of Arabia.

Sirocco: Southerly from North Africa to southern Europe.

Zonda wind: On the eastern slope of the Andes in Argentina.

DO YOU KNOW?

Mountain and valley wind systems influence the weather pattern of the mountain top and valley bottom. Mountain top can be seen clearly at early morning and valley bottom at evening. But mountain top will be covered with clouds at evening due to rising of valley wind system and valley bottom would be covered by clouds at early morning due to arrival of mountain wind system. These clouds are sometimes called as 'fog' which is used for cultivation in the dry regions like Yemen.

6.4.10 Jet Streams

Jet streams are high altitude westerly wind system blows at a height of 6 to 14 km, with very high speed up to 450 km/hr in wavy form at both hemispheres. As they encircle the poles they are called as 'Circum polar wind system' (Figure 6.19).

Although the jet streams flow at higher altitude they also influences the surface weather pattern of the Earth.

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